

How Engineering Influences me as a Writer

Hello, my name is Matthew Cruz. I am a senior Mechanical Engineering student in the CECS department of the University of Central Florida. This path was a means of learning interdisciplinary information of fundamental engineering concepts, a so-called jack of all trades. For instance, there are the main concepts like mechanical, thermal, and fluid systems; however, our curriculum does include Electrical Engineering and Computer Science principles. As a writer I am shaped by my engineering background, my preference for logical and informative communication, my unfolding argumentative skills, and my reliance on technology to organize and present ideas effectively.

Some major points of my writing career would include my philosophy, mathematics, and coding classes. These were fundamental as they each built had a part in building my rhetoric usage of logos when interacting with others. This can be seen when reviewing previous essays of mine; where there is avoidance in changing the way an audience would feel and an emphasis on logic. This is to imply that there may be an over-reliance on informative works considering the aforementioned subjects. The way I leave comments can be seen with the “/***/” formatting which came from my coding classes; with one major problem being that it may not be intuitive for other readers of my work without prior experience. There is also a focus on analysis in my works, corresponding to my website guide, my analysis of game character design, and maybe even my logic work for Discrete Structures. This culminates in the notion that I may actually enjoy explaining and teaching about certain concepts.

Importance, as for a majority of readers and writers, can be decided by something they enjoy and the belief that it deserves to be read or spoken of. I am not an exception to this concept, which can be seen by my earlier statement that learning and teaching others is enjoyable even if it does not focus on my opinion on it. This relies on the construct that the willingness to teach someone about a new subject would imply that you think it is interesting enough to begin with; or in other words the notion that you would speak of something because it is appealing in this case. This importance was discovered when I made my guide and noticed a common theme across my works or rather the absence of content that attempts to make an argument for a specific opinion. All in all, it would be safe to say that informative works will probably be a staple in my future.

At the beginning of English Composition I, I set the goal of being prepared for Mechanical Engineering Design I which is the beginning of the end for my time at the University of Central Florida. It is an intensive process that requires an immense amount of documentation which is imperative considering that the majority of that class will be planning a design that will be built in Mechanical Engineering Design II. Currently that goal is within reach, as this class had a focus on something that I had very little experience in; argumentative works that are well organized and insist upon their existence. The essays and responses that were designed for this course were experiences that reinforced our argumentative skills. For instance, the Discuss sections on the course placed an emphasis on students' thoughts and our previous essays also encourage the same with their topics aligning with the concept of what literacy is.

My writing process can be treated as something that looks normal when writing informative pieces. First comes a draft of the work, then reciting the text to myself as this helps when recognizing ‘wordiness’ and concepts that do not come off as clearly as expected. If the text remains unconcise, then it must be completely re-worded as there should be no room for confusion. This process takes an extra step when writing in the argumentative format, as the audience is no longer one that is informed, but rather convinced. In regard to the template, organization is significantly affected as the reader will lose interest if topics are misappropriated and are not in a digestible format. More often than not I take more breaks when writing argumentative pieces as they require peace of mind and constant re-evaluation as one continues writing.

When writing some might prefer pen and paper and while I do enjoy the look of it, it is sadly very cumbersome to replicate well without practice. Fountain pens are also incredible means of delivering written media but rely on the writing system going from left-to-right or vice versa and a specific dominant hand, otherwise pages could end up smeared and precious work could be lost. It is one of the many reasons why computers are so great, as they allow anyone regardless of writing skill to arrive or go above the same level as written works. This leads to formatting my works in the form of discussion posts, websites, and building those same websites. Both methods of writing are still important as the message might flip on its head when written on paper placing more importance on the piece.

Reflecting on my previous experiences as a writer has shown me that any older notions of myself were somewhat close, but it also showed me parts that I had not recognized before now. While I knew that I preferred informative and analytical writing, it wasn't as obvious how consistently my engineering, mathematics, and coding background homed in the way I communicate to others. Throughout this essay, I realized that the majority of my writing is more or less determined by a need to explain concepts in a clear, logical, and efficient manner. Concurrently this course helped me learn new skills that are more effective in argumentative writing. It was an area that I originally did not have much experience in and would be important in my personal and academic career. Something to gather from this reflection is a good portion of writing will be shaped by the experiences, interests, and goals of writers rather than the things they dislike. Understanding bigger influences like those gives writers the means to recognize both their strengths and areas they need to grow. For me, this awareness will help me proceed further as an engineer and communicator, such that I will be able to present ideas more effectively to others while understanding more complex thoughts rather than just the latter.